

Problem solving

Whether it's a flat tire or torn clothes, tricky schoolwork or difficult life events, being able to identify a problem and come up with a solution is an important life skill.

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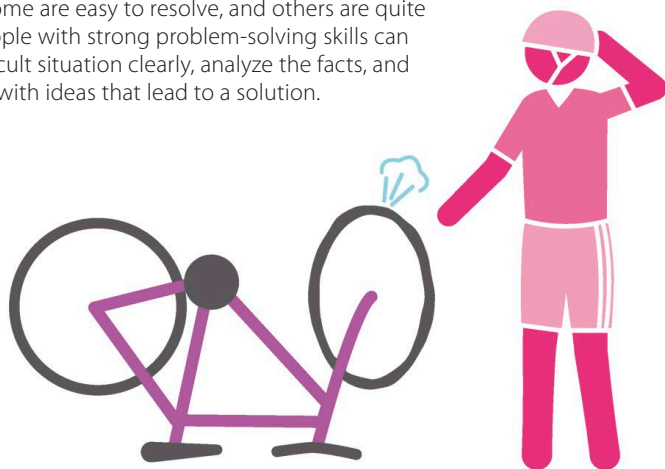
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Overcoming obstacles

People encounter challenges, problems, setbacks, and obstacles all the time. Some problems are small, others are big, some are easy to resolve, and others are quite tricky. People with strong problem-solving skills can see a difficult situation clearly, analyze the facts, and come up with ideas that lead to a solution.



TEEN HINTS

Feeling overwhelmed

- Try to think of a problem as an opportunity to change and improve something.
- Take a step back to see the reality of the situation—it might not be as bad as you think.
- If a problem is making you anxious, speak to friends or family who can support you.

◀ Stay calm

Many problems can leave teens feeling fed up or frustrated, but staying calm and thinking things through will help them find a solution faster.

Steps to take

When something goes wrong, it's easy to get discouraged, but the most practical and productive reaction is to take active steps toward working out a solution to the problem. Often the first attempt may not succeed, but failing is a great way to learn what doesn't work. Teens shouldn't feel disheartened, as everyone makes mistakes or fails at some point, and the knowledge they gain will help with the next attempt.

▽ Find a solution

These steps will help teens to figure out how best to approach and overcome their problems.

Identify the problem

Think about the situation and work out exactly what it is that you want to change. Know what a successful resolution of the issue would look like to you.

Think of possible solutions

Come up with as many ideas as possible; don't stop at the first. Think about, or write a list of, the pros and cons for each idea. Think about the amount of time it would take, the cost, who you need to speak to, if it is realistic, and whether or not you would need help.

Choose the best option

Think carefully about the facts of the situation, and based on the pros and cons, choose the most suitable solution for the problem. Speak to someone you trust if you're still not sure. Keep in mind a back-up option, in case the first attempt doesn't work out.